POWERPLAY: OFFICIAL INSTRUCTION MANUAL

I. INITIAL PUBLIC OFFERING (GAME SETUP)

1. Establish Liquidity (The Supply)

- Create three distinct, easily accessible supply piles for the tokens: **Power (P)**, **Influence (IP)**, and **Coins (C)**. This is the central bank.
- **Coin Denominations:** The Coin supply should consist of 30 tokens of **1-value** and 20 tokens of **5-value**.

2. Prepare the Paperwork (The Decks)

- Shuffle the **Action Deck** (a single pile) and place it face down. Every Action card is free to play; the optional **Influencing Decision** (1 Influence) is paid at the moment a card is played, to fire a third Asset. See **Activation Ladder** in the Glossary.
  - **Action Deck**: **40 cards** = 20 different designs × 2 copies each. Each card carries a **primary and a secondary Industry**; 4 designs are primary-tagged to each of the 5 Industries.
- Shuffle the **Reaction Deck** (a single pile) and place it face down. Every Reaction card is free to play.
  - **Reaction Deck**: **30 cards** = 10 different designs × 3 copies each. Each Reaction carries a **single Industry**; 2 designs per Industry.
- Shuffle the **Event Deck** and place it face down.
  - **Event Deck**: **18 cards** (6 positive · 12 negative), 1 copy each.
- Separate the **Asset Cards** into three draw piles by Tier (T1, T2, T3). Shuffle each pile individually and place them face down.
  - **T1 Asset Pile**: 7 designs × 2 copies = **14 cards**
  - **T2 Asset Pile**: 9 designs × 2 copies = **18 cards**
  - **T3 Asset Pile**: 5 designs × 2 copies = **10 cards**

*Action and Reaction cards carry no Power requirement. Power Floors apply to Assets only: your Power gates which Assets you can buy and which Assets can fire through synergy (see **Buy Floor**, **Use Floor**, **Activation Ladder**).*

3. Determine the Market Leader (First Player Selection)

- The Board must establish dominance early. Players may collectively agree on *one* of the following metrics to determine who picks their Character first and takes the first turn:
  - **Liquid Assets:** Whoever currently has a physical $100 bill on their person.
  - **Global Footprint:** Whoever went on a foreign trip most recently. *(Loophole: Any player currently visiting from a foreign country automatically wins this category).*
  - **Depreciating Assets:** Whoever owns the most expensive car.
  - **Wearable Wealth:** Whoever is wearing the most expensive watch.
  - **The Power Move:** Whoever went to the toilet last.
- Place the **Leader Token** in front of the player selected based on the rules above.

4. The Org Chart (Character Selection & Starting Capital)

- Starting with the First Player and proceeding clockwise, players select one **Character** from the available roster.
  - ***HR Addendum (The "Tom" Rule):*** Anyone named "Tom" must pick their character *last*, regardless of the First Player metric. However, this penalty only applies to character selection; Tom retains their standard seat in the clockwise turn order.

- Once Characters are selected, each player collects their **Starting Stats** (Coins and Influence tokens) exactly as printed on their Character card. **Every character starts with 0 Power** — Power is fully earned in play.
- Each player also takes a **Power Track** (a personal dial) and sets it to **0**. The Track reads **0–9, then 10 → 100 by tens**, and its printed labels mark what each Power level unlocks — **1: Character Ability**, **2: Tier 2 Assets**, **3: Tier 3 Assets**, **4: PowerPlay!** — one new unlock per rung. Your Track always shows your current Power; move the dial up or down as you gain or spend it.
- Each player also takes **two (2) Deal Tokens** from the supply. Every deal costs each party one Deal Token; both tokens come back at the **Opening Bell** hand refill each round.
- Each player also takes **two (2) Reroll Tokens** from the supply. A Reroll Token is spent to reroll **one** of your income dice during your income roll; tokens are **one-time use and are never replenished** — once both are gone, your rolls stand.

5. Distribute Initial Portfolios (Starting Hands)

- Every player draws exactly **Three (3) Action cards** (from the Action deck) and **Two (2) Reaction cards** (from the Reaction deck) to form their starting hand. Keep these hidden.
- All of these cards are free to play with no Power requirement — every player can use their starting hand immediately.

6. Commence Hostilities

- Turn order proceeds clockwise (to the left) starting from the First Player.

II. GLOSSARY OF TERMS (THE LEGAL FRAMEWORK)

- **Ability Lock:** When a player's Power drops below an Asset's Use Floor, that Asset's Synergy is locked — it cannot fire even when a matching card is played. Income still flows normally and Operating Costs must still be paid. The Synergy unlocks automatically when the player's Power meets or exceeds the Use Floor again.
- **Activation Ladder:** The synergy-firing mechanism on Action cards. Each Action card carries **2 Industries** (primary + secondary). When an Attacker plays an Action card:
  - **Base** (free with card play): the card's base effect resolves, AND **2 Assets the Attacker owns that match the card's primary Industry** fire their Synergy clauses.
  - **Influencing Decision** (pay **1 Influence** — the single, optional upgrade): the **secondary Industry is unlocked**, and **1 more Asset fires** — the third fire may come from **either** Industry (Attacker's choice). **Total: 3 Assets fire.**

  Per-Asset cap: each Asset can fire at most once per card play (so the Base needs 2 *different* primary-Industry Assets, and the Influencing Decision needs 3 *different* matching Assets in total). **The Asset Use Floor gates each pick** — the Attacker can only choose Assets they currently meet the Use Floor for (T1 = 0 P, T2 = 2 P, T3 = 3 P). **If the Attacker owns no matching-Industry Assets**, the base effect still resolves, no Influencing Decision cost is paid, and no Synergy fires; if they own fewer matching Assets than the fire count allows, the available Assets fire and the rest is forfeit.

  Cost commitment: At declaration time, the Attacker can only declare the Influencing Decision if they currently hold its full cost (**1 Influence on hand**). No IOUs, no partial commitments — without 1 Influence, the card resolves at Base.

  Reactions use a simpler model: when a Reaction is played, **1 matching-Industry Asset the Reactor owns fires automatically** — no cost, no ladder.

  Targeting: when any Asset's Synergy clause fires, the **owner of the Asset picks the target** of the effect; **self-target is allowed unless the clause explicitly names "an opponent."** See **Synergy Target Rule**.

  Reactions on synergy fires (Sequential Synergy Resolution): synergy fires resolve **sequentially, one at a time, in the order declared by the Attacker**. Each fire is a discrete event: before it resolves, a **response window** opens

for the player it targets — that player (or a Reactor defending them) may play a Reaction against that specific fire. With the Influencing Decision (3 fires), up to 3 separate response windows exist. **Priority within a window:** if two or more players wish to React to the same fire, the player earliest in turn order from the Leader has priority; the **affected player always has first right** — a third-party Reactor may act only if the affected player declines. No Reaction may be played in response to a Reaction — each Reaction is the end of its chain (chains are scoped per fire).

"Synergy card" in Event Objectives: an Event Objective that reads "*Play a [Industry] synergy card*" is satisfied by playing **any card with that Industry as its primary OR secondary tag**.

- **Attach:** A card persists on a target Asset (or player) until a condition is met or its specified duration expires, then is discarded. Each attached card specifies its own duration in card text. In the base game, no Action card attaches — the four Infrastructure-primary Actions (Compliance Fine, Patent Violation, Grid Modernization, Public Works) are Instant. The Attach keyword stays in the glossary for Events, future Assets, and expansion content; financial tokens (Loans, IOUs) also track as attached state.

  General attachment cleanup: At each player's Organize the Desk phase, remove any Attached cards whose duration has expired. Financial tokens (Loans, IOUs) follow their own rules and are NOT cleared at Organize the Desk.
- **Attacker:** Player who played the Action card.
- **Buy Floor:** The minimum Power a player must hold to draw from an Asset deck, pull an Asset of that tier into the Market Operation draft row, or acquire one via Private Equity. **T1 = 0 P, T2 = 2 P, T3 = 3 P** — the same values as the Asset Use Floor. In the Market Operation draft, pulling a T2/T3 card into the row also requires holding ½ its printed cost in Coins (T2 ≥ 4 C, T3 ≥ 7 C). Power is checked, not spent.
- **Bankrupt:** A state a player enters when they must pay Coins and cannot, even after liquidating all Assets. This results in player elimination.
- **Bonus Effect:** Optional additional effect requiring extra cost.
- **Character Action:** A **Free Action** you may use at the moment printed on your Character card. Character abilities are **free** (no Coin, Influence, or Power is spent on activation), require a **Power Floor of 1 P** (checked, not spent), and are **gated** — each ability specifies the phase, or the event (such as making a deal or paying loan maintenance), during which it may be activated. Frequency: **once per round**. A character ability can be reacted to.
- **Counter:** Respond to an Action card or to an individual Asset Synergy fire by playing a Reaction. A Counter **mitigates** (reduces or compensates); it does not fully negate the trigger. Any Reaction can Counter any Action or any single fire.
- **Deal-making (Trading & Negotiation):** Voluntary, binding, two-party deals — eligible contents are Action / Reaction cards (from hand), Asset cards (ownership transfers; the new owner inherits the Asset's state), Coins, and IOUs. **Influence and Power are never tradable** (converting your own resources is not trading). **Deals may be struck at any time a player is not engaged in a resolution** — on any player's turn (including between the two Action cards of a PowerPlay! turn), during the Lunch Break, and during Call-it-a-Night Debt Settlement. **Not permitted** while an Action card, a Synergy fire, or a Reaction is resolving, or while Market Operation bids are sealed or being resolved. **Cap: 2 deals per player per round, tracked with Deal Tokens** — each player holds 2; a deal costs each party 1 token; tokens refill to 2 at the Opening Bell hand refill. A Strategic Access deal (the Lobbyist) costs neither party a token. Multi-party arrangements resolve as chains of bilateral deals. A creditor may sell an outstanding IOU to a third party as part of a deal (the buyer collects from the original debtor at Call-it-a-Night).
- **Debt Settlement:** A sub-phase of Call-it-a-Night, between Currency Conversion and Thievery, where outstanding loans and IOUs are resolved. **Deal-making and loans remain available during this sub-phase** — a debtor may borrow or trade in the moment to fund a repayment. Sub-steps in order: (a) voluntary loan principal repayment; (b) loan maintenance fees due (1 C × active loans, except in the round of acquisition — the grace round); (c) voluntary IOU repayment; (d) IOU negotiation between Defender and Attacker; (e) forced IOU liquidation if unpaid (Defender

chooses an unencumbered Asset to liquidate; cascades through additional Assets if needed); (f) elimination only if IOUs remain unpaid AND no unencumbered Assets remain AND no negotiated agreement is reached.

- **Defender:** Player targeted by the Action.
- **Event Objective:** Every **Universal Event** card carries an **Objective** — an immediately-checkable condition paired with a reward. The reward is **1 Power**, uniform across all events. While the event is active, **any player who meets the condition claims the reward in the moment, once per player per event** (mark it claimed; it resets when the event is replaced). A condition is either a state threshold (e.g., "own 3 or more Assets"), a discrete trigger (e.g., "when you acquire an Asset"), or a **cumulative count** explicitly labelled as such (e.g., "Gain 3 or more Coins (cumulative)"). Two Universal Events are active each round (the **Morning News** and the **Afternoon News**), so a player may claim **both** Objectives per round. Event Objectives are the game's primary route to gaining Power.
- **Frozen:** An Asset in the Frozen state cannot fire its Synergy; it still earns income. No base-game card currently produces a Frozen state — the keyword stays in the glossary for Events, Assets, and future expansion content.
- **Greenwashing transaction:** A Coin → Influence conversion shortcut available **only while the Environmental Lobby Universal Event is active**. On your turn, you may use your **Standard Action** to convert **3 Coins → 1 Influence** (the standard conversion rate, available on demand mid-turn at the cost of your Standard Action). Performing this transaction satisfies the Environmental Lobby Objective.
- **Industry Synergy:** Every card (Action and Reaction) carries an Industry tag, and the synergy is the **Asset firing mechanism**. When an Action is played, its Industry triggers Asset firing through the **Activation Ladder** (2 Assets fire at Base; 3 with the Influencing Decision). When a Reaction is played, 1 matching-Industry Asset fires automatically. The fired Asset's own Synergy clause produces the value; only the playing player's Assets are checked (the **Attacker** for Action cards, the **Reactor** for Reaction cards), gated by the Asset Use Floor, and that player picks the target per the **Synergy Target Rule**.
- **Information:** Private knowledge a player holds — such as the contents of their hand, their current resource totals, cards they have seen, or their future intentions. Information has no token representation but is a tradeable commodity.
- **IOU (Debt):** A resource obligation, settled later, **owed by one player to another (player ↔ player — the Defender owes the Attacker)**. Distinct from a Loan, which is player ↔ supply. When an Action card effect demands a resource the Defender lacks (insufficient Influence, Power, or Coins), the Defender takes on a Coin-denominated IOU instead, held by the Attacker. **Conversion rates**: insufficient Influence → 4 C per IP (3 + 1 interest); insufficient Power → 7 C per P (6 + 1 interest); insufficient Coin → (X+1) C. **Cap**: max 2 new IOUs per Defender per round (subsequent debt triggers floor at 0). **Settlement**: at the Call-it-a-Night Debt Settlement sub-phase. The Defender may pay voluntarily or negotiate with the Attacker (forgiveness, asset trades, etc.). If unpaid: the Defender chooses an unencumbered Asset to liquidate (Asset → discard, Defender receives printed cost from the bank, pays the Attacker MIN(IOU, available Coins); cascades through additional unencumbered Assets if the IOU is still unpaid). If no unencumbered Assets remain and no negotiated agreement is reached, the Defender is **eliminated from the game**. **Tradable** in any deal (a creditor may sell an IOU to a third party — see Deal-making). **Attacker elimination wipes their held IOUs**.
- **Lose:** A player reduces their Coins, Influence (IP), or Power (P). The card text will specify the amount and destination.
- **Loan (Corporate Debt):** Voluntary capital from the supply (player ↔ bank — no Attacker / Defender relationship; the bank is your counterparty). Loans are secured against an Asset (collateral). **Loans may be taken at any time the borrower is not engaged in a resolution**: on any turn, during the Lunch Break, during Call-it-a-Night Debt Settlement, or during Bankruptcy Resolution — but not while an Action, Synergy fire, or Reaction is resolving, and not while Market Operation bids are sealed or being resolved. Taking a loan never consumes a Standard Action. Loans are tracked as tokens attached to specific Assets — the Asset becomes Mortgaged. **Max 2 active loans per player** (checked whenever a loan is taken — you may not take a 3rd). **Maintenance fee**: 1 Coin per active loan, paid to the supply at Call-it-a-Night, except in the round of acquisition (grace round). **Voluntary repayment** (at

Call-it-a-Night Debt Settlement): pay principal + 1 Coin to clear; the Asset is unmortgaged. **Loan default** (missed maintenance, more than 2 loans, or end-of-game Clean the Books): the attached Asset → discard pile; the bank pays the player the printed cost; the player pays the loan dues (principal + 1 C) to the bank; the player keeps the surplus (= printed cost − principal − 1; 1 C / 3 C / 6 C for T1 / T2 / T3). Loan discharged. **No elimination from loan default** (in contrast to IOU default — IOUs are player-to-player; see IOU). **Mortgaged Assets cannot be sold** (to the bank, to a player, via character abilities, or any other means) while the loan is active — repay the loan at Call-it-a-Night Debt Settlement to unmortgage the Asset before it can be sold. Mortgaged Assets still earn income.

- **PowerPlay!:** A Free Action in which the active player pays **2 Power** to unlock a burst turn. **Power Floor 4** — you must hold at least 4 Power to activate it (checked), then you spend 2 of it. Once per turn. Because every character starts at 0 Power, PowerPlay! is a mid-to-late-game play reached through Event Objectives, Tier 3 Signing Bonuses and Power-granting Synergy fires, or Influence → Power conversion at 2 IP = 1 P. Spending from exactly 4 Power leaves you at 2 — below the Tier 3 Use Floor — so your Tier 3 Synergies are locked until you climb back (see Ability Lock).

  What PowerPlay! grants:

  - **Play up to 2 Action cards this turn** (instead of the usual 1).
  - Each Action card fires its **Base 2 primary-Industry Asset Synergies** as normal (the Base is free for everyone).
  - **One free Influencing Decision** — choose exactly **1** of your Action cards this turn to receive the **Influencing Decision** with its 1-Influence cost **waived**: that Action's secondary Industry is unlocked and it fires 3 Assets instead of 2. The other Action may still buy the Influencing Decision at its normal 1 Influence.
  - **Draw 1 Action card and 1 Reaction card** from their respective decks.

  Every Synergy fire a PowerPlay! produces opens a normal response window. The PowerPlay! activation itself cannot be reacted to only because it has no effect of its own — it is not a trigger.

  Cost commitment: Under PowerPlay!, the free Influencing Decision costs nothing; declaring a **second** Influencing Decision on the other Action requires holding its normal **1 Influence**. No IOUs and no partial commitments.

- **Power Track:** A per-player dial that displays the player's current **Power**. It reads **0–9 as single steps, then 10 → 100 by tens**. Labels next to specific rungs show what that Power level unlocks: **1 — Character Ability**, **2 — Tier 2 Asset** (Buy / Use floor), **3 — Tier 3 Asset** (Buy / Use floor), **4 — PowerPlay!**; one new unlock per rung, and rungs above 4 serve as buffer / scoring headroom. The Track is the visual form of every **Power Floor** (checked, not spent) — a player's access to an Asset tier, their Character Ability, and PowerPlay! is read live off the dial's current position.
- **Prevent:** Blocks a specific effect (loss or damage).
- **Redirect:** Sends an Action's effect to another player.
- **Reaction:** A card played from the hand, out of turn sequence, **in response to an Action card play, a synergy fire (an Asset Synergy clause triggering on a player), or an Event**. **Any player may react to any trigger, whether or not it affects them**: the Reaction's printed effect goes to the **Reactor** (a compensation such as "gain 2 Coins" or "draw a card" is theirs; a prevention such as "Prevent up to 2 Coins of loss" protects the player the Reactor chooses to defend — themselves or the affected player), and the Reactor's own matching-Industry Asset fires. Reaction cards are the primary exception to turn-based play. **The player who plays a Reaction is the Reactor** (see Reactor). Reactions are **free to play** and carry **1 Industry** each — when a Reaction is played, **1 matching-Industry Asset the Reactor owns fires its Synergy clause automatically** (no activation cost, gated by the Asset Use Floor). Any Reaction can Counter any Action. **No Reaction-to-Reaction** — a Reaction cannot be played in response to another Reaction; the chain ends at the first Reaction. **Reactions may Counter synergy fires** — when an Action card fires an Asset's Synergy, the affected player may Counter that specific fire before it resolves; each Asset firing is a separate Counter opportunity. Fires resolve sequentially in the order declared by the Attacker; within a fire's response window the affected player has first right, and competing Reactors resolve in turn order from the Leader (see Activation Ladder).

  Reaction limits:

  - **Response-only:** a Reaction can never be played proactively on your own turn — only in response to a triggering Action, synergy fire, or Event.
  - **Mitigation, not negation:** Reactions **reduce or compensate** the triggering effect; they do not fully negate it. (Small effects that fit within the cap below may be fully prevented.)
  - **2-Coin mitigation cap:** a Reaction's direct prevention is capped at **2 Coins of value**.
  - **Compensation model:** when the triggering loss exceeds what the Reaction can prevent (e.g., an Influence loss, worth about 3 Coins, over the 2-Coin cap), the loss **resolves anyway** AND the Reactor gains the card's separate compensation reward (Coins or a card draw) — the net swing is reduced, not zeroed.
- **Reactor:** The player who plays a Reaction card. The Reactor may defend themselves or any other player (the "target player"), or react purely for their own gain. The Reactor is **not necessarily** the Defender — any player at the table may play a Reaction in response to an **Action card play**, a **synergy fire**, or an **Event**, whether or not it affects them. **The Reactor's synergy fire is aimed by the Reactor** — it need not hit the Attacker: if A plays against B and C reacts, C's Asset may fire against B, against A, or for C themselves. **Reactions cannot be played in response to other Reactions.** For a Reaction's Industry Synergy, the **Reactor's** owned Assets are checked, not the protected player's.
- **Resource Flow Notation:** Card text follows a consistent vocabulary for resource movement. `gain X` = receive from the supply (no transfer between players). `lose X` = lose to the supply (no transfer). `pay X to [player]` = direct transfer from one player to another. `take X from [player]` / `steal X from [player]` = transfer from the named player to the playing player. Default: when a card says "Attacker gains +Y" without specifying a source, the resource comes from the supply. When it says "Defender loses Y" without specifying a destination, the resource goes to the supply.
- **Reroll Token:** A one-time token (2 per player at setup). Spend one during your own income roll to reroll **one** income die; the new result stands (you may spend your second token on the same die). Spent tokens return to the supply and are **never replenished**.
- **Replace:** Discard 1 card of the specified type (e.g., Action) from your hand to draw 1 new card of that same type from its deck.
- **Sell: At any time you are not engaged in a resolution** (the same permitted-time rule as loans and deals), you may Sell an unmortgaged Asset you own — to the bank (return the Asset to the supply, gain Coins equal to its printed cost) or to another player (they pay you the printed cost and receive the Asset; a sale to a player is a deal and costs each party a Deal Token). Not while an Action, Synergy fire, or Reaction is resolving, and not while Market Operation bids are sealed or being resolved. Selling never consumes a Standard Action. Mortgaged Assets cannot be sold.
- **Signing Bonus:** A one-time resource grant the buyer gains the moment they acquire an Asset via the **Market Operation draft or Private Equity**. The bonus is printed on the Asset card and uniform within each tier: **T1 Assets have no Signing Bonus**; **T2 Assets grant "Gain 1 Influence"**; **T3 Assets grant "Gain 1 Power"**. The Signing Bonus applies once only — at acquisition. **The Signing Bonus does NOT apply to trades, forced transfers, or hostile transfers (e.g., Hostile Takeover).**
- **Starting Hand:** At setup, every player draws exactly **3 Action cards** and **2 Reaction cards** (from the single Action and Reaction decks respectively). Cards are free to play; no Power Floor applies to playing cards. See § I.5.
- **Synergy Target Rule:** When an Asset's Synergy clause fires (via an Action card at either Activation Ladder step, or via a Reaction card), the **owner of the Asset picks the target** of the resulting effect. **Self-target is allowed** — the owner may pick themselves, which can be useful for advancing Event Objectives (e.g., a "Gain 3 or more Coins (cumulative)" objective can be advanced by self-targeting a Coin-gain Asset). **Wording caveat:** if a Synergy clause names "an opponent" (e.g., *"An opponent pays you 3 Coins"*), self-target is excluded by the word — the effect requires a non-self opponent. If the clause names "a player" or has no explicit target, self-target is allowed. **On a**

Reaction's synergy fire the Reactor is the owner and chooses freely — in a three-player game where A attacks B and C reacts, C may aim C's Asset at B rather than at A.

- **Tier Floor Universal Application:** The Power Floor for each Asset tier applies to all Asset interactions: **drawing** from an Asset tier pile, **pulling** an Asset of that tier into the Market Operation draft, **acquiring** via Private Equity, and **firing** an Asset's Synergy. Specifically: **T1 Assets = 0 P**, **T2 = 2 P**, **T3 = 3 P**. Power is checked, not spent. Action and Reaction cards have no Power Floor. See Buy Floor, Use Floor.
- **Trigger:** An automatic ability that occurs when a specific game condition is met. The player does not spend an Action to make it happen.
- **Use:** Fire an Asset's Synergy or generate its income.
- **Use Floor:** The minimum Power a player must hold for an Asset's Synergy to fire. T1 = 0 P, T2 = 2 P, T3 = 3 P. If a player's Power drops below the Use Floor, the Synergy is locked (see Ability Lock). Power is checked, not spent.

III. THE ROUND STRUCTURE

A Round of PowerPlay represents a complete fiscal quarter and proceeds through seven phases in order. Hand refill happens at the Opening Bell, income is collected at Call-it-a-Night, and loans and deals can be struck at any time — so player turns are pure play. Every phase proceeds in **turn order from the Leader** unless noted.

1. Morning News

- Draw exactly **One (1) Universal Event** card — the **Morning News** — and **read it aloud**, then resolve its effects. *If the Event deck is empty, shuffle its discard pile into a new draw pile first.* One-shot effects resolve now and end; **its ongoing effects (income modifiers, cost changes, etc.) and its Event Objective stay active until the next round's Morning News replaces it** — the replaced event is then discarded. Every Universal Event carries an **Event Objective** (a Power-granting goal — see § II).

2. Opening Bell (Batch Upkeep)

In turn order from the Leader, each player completes their upkeep **before any player turns begin**.

- **Draw Hands:** Discard any number of cards from your hand (Actions and/or Reactions), then **refill to 3 Action cards + 2 Reaction cards**, drawing from the Action deck and Reaction deck respectively. *If a deck is empty, shuffle its discard pile first.* The 3A/2R hand size is a **refill target**, not a per-turn cap. *(The Tech Giant's Disruptive Innovation ability activates here, replacing the standard refill — either/or, not both. The Spy's Espionage ability activates after the Opening Bell completes.)*
- **Refill Deal Tokens:** each player's Deal Tokens return to **2**.
- Income is **not** collected at the Opening Bell — it is rolled at the start of Call-it-a-Night (§ III.7).
- Card buying is not part of the Opening Bell — players buy cards at **The Inbox**, the start of each of their turns (Action = 2 Coins, Reaction = 1 Coin; see § IV.A).

3. Market Operation (Pre-Market Sealed-Bid Draft)

The public asset market. Players bid with the Coins they hold — last night's income in Rounds 2–4, starting capital in Round 1.

1. **Opt in.** Each player decides whether to participate; a non-participant pulls no card and does not bid.
2. **Build the row.** In turn order from the Leader, each participant pulls the top card of one Asset Deck face-up into a shared **row** (one card per participant). **Pull eligibility:** T1 — any participant; T2 — Buy Floor 2 P **and** ≥ 4 Coins; T3 — Buy Floor 3 P **and** ≥ 7 Coins.
3. **Sealed bid.** Each participant secretly commits Coins in a closed hand; all reveal **simultaneously** (you cannot commit more than you hold). **Standard bid** ≥ ½ the printed cost of the Asset taken (T1 ≥ 2 / T2 ≥ 4 / T3 ≥ 7). A player at exactly **1 Coin** may make an **all-in bid**, resolve last, and take a leftover. **0 Coins** = does not participate.

4. **Resolve descending.** The highest bidder picks an Asset **of the tier they pulled into the row** (or a higher tier they meet the Buy Floor + ½-cost floor for), pays their bid to the bank, and gains its **Signing Bonus**; then the next-highest, and so on. **You buy what you pulled:** you may take a **lower**-tier Asset only if **no Asset of the tier you pulled remains in the row** — then you take an Asset of the **highest tier still available**, and you **still pay your full bid** (if only a Tier 1 is left, you take it at the price you bid — overpaying is the cost of the pull). The Buy Floor still applies: if every remaining Asset is above your Power, your bid is returned. **Ties:** turn order from the Leader. Non-acquirers' committed Coins are returned. *(The Tycoon's Market Squeeze ability activates after bids are revealed, adding 1 Coin to the Tycoon's own bid.)*
5. **Close.** Leftover Assets go to the bottom of their tier decks.

4. Market Manipulation — Phase 1 (First Player Turns)

All players take their **first** turn, in turn order from the Leader. A turn is **The Inbox** → **Action** → **Organize the Desk** (see § IV).

5. Lunch Break (Mid-Round Economy)

When play returns to the Leader, the table breaks for the mid-round economy window. **Sub-phases resolve in the following order**; within each sub-phase, individual player actions proceed **in turn order from the Leader**.

Lunch Break sub-phase order (Afternoon News → Private Equity):

1. **Afternoon News:** Draw **One (1) Universal Event** card — the **Afternoon News** — and **read it aloud**, then resolve its effects. *(Same Event deck as the Morning News; if it is empty, shuffle its discard pile first.)* Its ongoing effects and Event Objective stay active **until the next round's Afternoon News replaces it** — so the Afternoon event **overlaps into the next round's first half**; the replaced event is then discarded. A round therefore has **two Universal Events active at once** — the Morning News and the Afternoon News — **each with its own Event Objective**. *(The Media Mogul's Editorial Preview ability activates after the Afternoon News is drawn, peeking at the top card of the Event deck.)*
2. **Private Equity (Broker an Asset Deal):** In turn order from the Leader, each player may pay a Private Equity Fee (1 / 2 / 3 Coins for T1 / T2 / T3) to draw the top **2** cards of one Asset Deck you meet the Buy Floor for; buy 1 at its printed cost (gaining its Signing Bonus); discard the other. The full-price, on-demand counterpart to the Market Operation draft.

Loans, deals, and sales during the Lunch Break: players may also **take loans, strike deals, and sell Assets** throughout the Lunch Break, as at any other permitted time (see **Loan**, **Deal-making**, and **Sell** in § II; the Lobbyist's, the Investor's, and the CEO's abilities attach to the deal, loan, or sale itself, not to a sub-phase). A loan taken or an Asset sold before Private Equity funds that purchase.

6. Market Manipulation — Phase 2 (Second Player Turns)

All players take their **second** turn, in turn order from the Leader.

7. Call-it-a-Night (End of Round)

Resolve the round's books. Each player settles their **own** affairs **in turn order from the Leader**; only the contested IOU steps are interactive. Loans and deals remain available throughout.

- **Collect Revenue (Income Roll):** Roll **one income die per Asset tier you own** — **T1 = D4, T2 = D6, T3 = D10** — all together. The **die face is the Coins paid per Asset** of that tier you own; **each T1 Asset pays its die result + 1 Coin**. **Frozen Assets still earn income** (a freeze locks the Synergy only; see Frozen). Both active Universal Events (Morning and Afternoon) apply to this roll.
  - **Reroll Tokens:** You may spend a Reroll Token to reroll **one** of your income dice (one token per reroll; you may spend both on the same die). Tokens are one-time use and never replenished.
  - **Operating Costs (Tax):** Each T3 Asset costs **1 Coin** upkeep, deducted from your income before you collect. **T1 and T2 Assets have no upkeep.**

    - **Forced Bankruptcy:** If you cannot cover a required payment, immediately enter Bankruptcy Resolution. **An emergency Loan is available at once** (loans can be taken at any time — see Loan).
- **Currency Conversion:** Convert your own Tokens at the standard rates (3 Coins = 1 Influence | 2 Influence = 1 Power). *(Converting your own resources is not trading.)* Conversions are **forward-only** — Power → Influence and Influence → Coin **reverse conversions are not permitted** for any player or effect, with a **single exception**: the Oligarch's **Dynasty** ability may convert 1 Influence → 3 Coins during Call-it-a-Night, once per round. No other reverse conversion is allowed.
- **Debt Settlement** (loans and deals permitted throughout), in order: (a) **voluntary loan principal repayment**; (b) **loan maintenance fees** (1 Coin × active loans, except the grace round of acquisition; missed maintenance → loan default per the Loan entry); (c) **voluntary IOU repayment**; (d) **IOU negotiation** (Defender ↔ Attacker — forgiveness, partial payment, asset trades, favors); (e) **forced IOU liquidation** if still unpaid (the Defender liquidates an unencumbered Asset → discard, the bank pays the printed cost, the Defender pays the Attacker MIN(IOU, Coins); cascades through further unencumbered Assets; Loans cannot be taken here); (f) **elimination** only if IOUs remain unpaid AND no unencumbered Assets remain AND no agreement is reached (owed and held IOUs are wiped).
- **Thievery:** If the player with the *lowest* total Power is not already the Leader, they steal the **Leader Token** and assign it to any player (including themselves). *Ties for lowest Power → the tied player earliest in turn order assigns.*
- *If this is not the final round, a new Round begins with **Morning News**.*

IV. TURN STRUCTURE

A player's turn (during Market Manipulation Phase 1 and Phase 2) is lean: hand refill happens at the **Opening Bell**, income at **Call-it-a-Night**, Asset buying at the **Market Operation** and the **Lunch Break**, and per-turn card acquisition at **The Inbox** (start of your turn). Loans, deals, and Asset sales can happen at any time you are not inside a resolution. Your turn is **The Inbox → Action → Organize the Desk**.

A. The Inbox

At the start of your turn, you may **buy up to 1 Action card and up to 1 Reaction card**. For each:

- **Action card**: pay **2 Coins** to the supply, draw the top 2 cards of the Action deck, keep 1, discard the other.
- **Reaction card**: pay **1 Coin** to the supply, draw the top 2 cards of the Reaction deck, keep 1, discard the other.

Buying is optional — you may buy 0, 1, or 2 cards per turn. The **inverted price** *(Action 2 C > Reaction 1 C)* reflects the relative power gap: Action cards carry the Activation Ladder (up to 3 Asset fires + base effect) while Reaction cards fire 1 Asset + base. The Opening Bell still includes the free Draw Hands refill to 3A/2R.

No hand-starvation safety net. If you have 0 cards in hand and 0 Coins, you cannot draw at The Inbox — you wait for the next Opening Bell free refill. Hand starvation is a real strategic failure state; manage your Coin budget for Inbox buying (synergy activation itself costs no Coins; the Influencing Decision costs 1 Influence).

B. Action Phase

Take **one (1) Standard Action**:

- **Play an Action Card:** Play one Action card from your hand (free) and resolve its effects — the base effect, then your Asset fires through the Activation Ladder. Every Action card always has a legal target.

Leaving your Standard Action unused is allowed (no reward, no penalty).

(Action cards or Asset Synergies may grant additional Standard Actions; when a source grants +1 Action, your budget increases and you may take another.)

Free Actions (do not consume your Standard Action):

- **Take a Character Action:** Use your Character Ability at its printed moment (a phase, or an event such as making a deal). Character abilities are **free** (no Coin, Influence, or Power spent on activation), require a **Power Floor of 1 P**

(checked, not spent), and are phase- or event-gated. **Once per round.**

- **PowerPlay!:** Hold at least **4 Power** (Power Floor, checked) and pay **2 Power** to unlock the burst turn. **Play up to 2 Action cards this turn** (each fires its Base 2 primary-Industry Synergies as normal); **one** of them receives the **Influencing Decision free** (secondary Industry unlocked, 3 fires — the other may buy it at the normal 1 Influence). Draw **1 Action card + 1 Reaction card**. Every fire opens a normal response window. **Once per turn.** *(See PowerPlay! in the Glossary.)*

C. Organize the Desk

- **Attach Cleanup**: Remove any expired Attached cards from your Assets and from yourself. No base-game Action card attaches — this slot handles Event-produced attachments and any future expansion content. Financial tokens (Loans, IOUs) are tracked separately.

(There is no per-turn discard step — your hand is reset to the 3A/2R refill target at the next Opening Bell. Loan maintenance and repayment are handled at Call-it-a-Night, and the 2-loan cap is checked whenever a loan is taken.)

D. Hand Size

Your hand is refilled to **3 Action cards + 2 Reaction cards** at the Opening Bell (free). This is a **refill target**, not a strict cap: during the round you may buy up to 1 Action and 1 Reaction at each of your turns via **The Inbox** (Action 2 C, Reaction 1 C) and play your hand down freely; there is no end-of-turn discard.

V. FISCAL TIMELINE

THE FISCAL YEAR (4 Rounds)

- **Player Count:** Requires **3 to 5 players**. The game does not support fewer than 3 or more than 5 active seats. Any additional participants must join as **spectators only**.
- **Duration:** The game is **4 rounds — one round per fiscal quarter, one full fiscal year per game**. It concludes at the end of the 4th *Call-it-a-Night* phase. With two turns per round, each player takes **8 turns** in total.

VI. CLEAN THE BOOKS

Before the Board Meeting can begin, the board must be perceived as beyond reproach. After the final Call-it-a-Night phase, **all players must immediately settle every outstanding loan**.

- **Forced Repayment:** Each player chooses for each outstanding Loan: either pay (principal + 1 Coin) to discharge the Loan and unmortgage the Asset, OR allow the Loan to default per the Loan default mechanic (attached Asset → discard, bank pays printed cost, player pays loan dues, player keeps surplus).
- **No new loans may be taken during Clean the Books.**
- **Order:** Debts are resolved in turn order, one player at a time.
- **No elimination from loan default at Clean the Books** — every loan can be discharged via voluntary payment OR default. Loan default never causes elimination. *(Elimination from financial pressure happens only via IOU forced liquidation at Call-it-a-Night, not via end-game loan resolution.)*
- **Discard all Events:** Both active Universal Events (the Morning News and the Afternoon News) and the Event deck are discarded.

VII. THE BOARD MEETING (END GAME SCORING)

When Clean the Books concludes, players must liquidate their empires and calculate their Total Power to determine the winner.

The Final Valuation Formula: `Total Power = (Power Tokens) + floor(Influence / 2) + floor(Coins / 6) + floor(Total Asset Value / 5)` *(Note: Always round down. The board does not reward fractions of a success).*

*The Board values a **diversified portfolio** over a fat checking account. Liquid Coins score at `floor(C / 6)` while owned Assets score at `floor(Asset Value / 5)` — because cash on hand is for amateurs and the post-IPO market wants to see your moves on the cap table, not your savings.* Total Asset Value is the sum of the printed costs of every Asset you still own (4 C / 8 C / 14 C for T1 / T2 / T3).

The player with the most Total Power is declared the **POWER PLAYER**.

Tie-Breaker Protocol: In the event of a tie, corporate litigation is settled via a Best-of-3 match of **Rock, Paper, Scissors, Lizard, Spock**.



VIII. INFORMATION IS POWER (INTEL TRADING)

In PowerPlay, information is a valuable commodity. Players may trade **Information for resources** with any other player **at any time** — during their own turn, during another player's turn, or between phases. No action is spent to initiate a trade.

What counts as Information:

- Revealing one or more cards from your hand (Action or Reaction cards)
- Disclosing your current resource totals (Coins, Influence, Power)
- Sharing knowledge of cards you have seen (e.g., via Character Abilities, Asset effects, etc.)
- Revealing your intentions, plans, or strategy

The Deal: Players negotiate freely. Either party may propose the exchange. Terms — what information is revealed and what resources change hands — are decided entirely by mutual agreement. There is no fixed rate.

Binding vs. Non-Binding: The information exchange itself (revealing or sharing) and any immediate resource payment are binding the moment both parties agree. Any *future* promises attached to a deal (e.g., "I won't target you next round") are **verbal and non-binding** — PowerPlay does not enforce future commitments.

IX. BANKRUPTCY

If a player enters a **negative balance**, they have until the **next Organize the Desk phase of their turn** to recover:

- **If they go negative on their own turn:** They have until the Organize the Desk phase of that same turn to resolve the debt.
- **If they go negative on another player's turn** (e.g., from an Event, Reaction, or another player's Action): They have until the Organize the Desk phase of their **next** turn to resolve the debt.

During that window, the player may:

1. Sell Assets to regain a positive balance (at any permitted time)
2. Strike deals with other players (at any permitted time)

3. Take a Loan against an Asset for half its printed cost — available immediately, at any permitted time (1 Coin maintenance per round at Call-it-a-Night Debt Settlement, voluntary repayment at principal + 1 Coin)

If the player **liquidates all Assets and remains negative** by the end of their recovery window, they must either:

- Secure funding from another player
- Take a Loan (if they still have an Asset to collateralise)
- Exit the game (elimination)

Quick answers:

- **Hand size** is fixed at 3 Action cards + 2 Reaction cards for every player count.
- **One Standard Action per turn**; two turns per round.
- **Character Action** is a Free Action, once per round (one use across both of your turns). It does not consume your Standard Action.